

Assignment #1: Designing and Implementing a New Tetris Gameplay Experience

Design Rationale & Gameplay Impact

5-Block Tetromino

Design & Purpose

I created a 5-block L-shaped tetromino. Its extended tail makes placement more challenging, but it can be very effective for clearing multiple lines when used strategically. The goal was to break standard Tetris patterns and push players to adapt.

Custom Gameplay Scenario

The 5-block L-shaped piece is now fully implemented. Players can use it to set up multi-line clears or navigate tricky stacks, adding new strategic opportunities and decision-making moments.

Implementation Challenges

Integrating the extra block required updating rotation logic, collision detection, and spawn behavior to work with the standard Tetris grid while keeping the gameplay balanced.

Gameplay Impact

The 5-block L-shaped piece adds tension, strategy, and variety. Players must plan ahead and take risks to earn higher rewards. It refreshes the core Tetris mechanics while fitting naturally into the game.